

# Nielsen Norman Group

# Heuristic Evaluation

# Workbook

Use this workbook to conduct your own heuristic evaluation.

For each of Jakob's 10 Usability Heuristics, look for specific places where the interface fails to adhere to the guideline. Write your recommendations for how to fix those usability issues.

<https://www.nngroup.com/articles/ten-usability-heuristics/>

Nielsen Norman Group

## Heuristic Evaluation

## Workbook

Evaluator:

Date:

Product:

Task:



## Visibility of System Status

The design should always keep users informed about what is going on, through appropriate feedback within a reasonable amount of time.

Does the design clearly communicate its state? Is feedback presented quickly after user actions?



### Issues

#### Screen: Home screen

In the Home screen, the bottom navigation bar highlights the "Search" icon (magnifying glass) as active, but the page content shows the "Explore" dashboard rather than a search interface.

### Recommendations

Ensure the active state of the navigation icons correctly matches the current page content.

## 2

## Match Between System and the Real World

The design should speak the users' language. Use words, phrases, and concepts familiar to the user, rather than internal jargon. Follow real-world conventions, making information appear in a natural and logical order.

Will user be familiar with the terminology used in the design? Do the design's

controls follow real-world conventions?



### Issues

#### Screen: Profile

The "Done" button and "Back" arrow are both present at the top, but it isn't immediately clear if "Done" saves the changes or if the "Back" arrow discards them.

### Recommendations

Use more explicit labels like "Save Changes" instead of "Done" to ensure the action matches the user's intent to update their information.

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## ● User Control and Freedom

Users often perform actions by mistake. They need a clearly marked "emergency exit" to leave the unwanted action without having to go through an extended process.

- Does the design allow users to go back a step in the process?
- Are exit links easily discoverable?
- Can users easily cancel an action? Is
- *Undo* and *Redo* supported?

### Issues

#### Screen: My Schedule

The user don't have a way to go back step in the process,  
  
Theres no cancel button or redo the schedule

### Recommendations

Include a "Cancel" button or a "Close" (X) icon, particularly if the user is in the middle of creating or editing an itinerary, allowing them to exit without saving changes.

For the schedule itself, include a "Reset Schedule" button to allow users to start over or an "Edit" mode to modify individual entries without needing to delete the entire plan.

## 4

## Consistency and Standards

Users should not have to wonder whether different words, situations, or actions mean the same thing. Follow platform and industry conventions.

- Does the design follow industry conventions?
- Are visual treatments used consistently throughout the design?

### Issues

**Naming Inconsistency:** The header on one screen says "Popular Places," while the home dashboard refers to them as "Best Destination".

### Recommendations

Standardize button components and terminology (e.g., choose either "Places" or "Destinations") across all frames to maintain a professional look and feel.

# Heuristic Evaluation Workbook



## Error Prevention

Good error messages are important, but the best designs carefully prevent problems from occurring in the first place. Either eliminate error-prone conditions, or check for them and present users with a confirmation option before they commit to the action.

- Does the design prevent slips by using helpful constraints?
- Does the design warn users before they perform risky actions?

### Issues

#### Screen: Sign up

The "Sign up" form asks for "Birth of date" and "Phone Number" immediately. If a user enters an invalid format, there are no visible constraints or examples to guide them *before* they click Register.

### Recommendations

Use input masks for the date (mm/dd/yyyy) and phone number fields to prevent users from submitting incorrect data.

## 6

## Recognition Rather Than Recall

Minimize the user's memory load by making elements, actions, and options visible. The user should not have to remember information from one part of the interface to another. Information required to use the design (e.g. field labels or menu items) should be visible or easily retrievable when needed.

- Does the design keep important information visible, so that users do not have to memorize it?
- Does the design offer help in-context?

### Issues

#### Screen: Map Search

In map the search bar contains the placeholder "Search attractions...". Once the user clicks into the map (MAP1), the search bar is still visible but empty. Users might forget what they were originally looking for if they navigate through multiple map layers.

### Recommendations

Keep the last searched term visible in the search bar or provide a "Recent Searches" dropdown to minimize the user's memory load.

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## Flexibility and Efficiency of Use

**Shortcuts — hidden from novice users — may speed up the interaction for the expert user such that the design can cater to both inexperienced and experienced users. Allow users to tailor frequent actions.**

- Does the design provide accelerators like keyboard shortcuts and touch gestures?
- Is content and functionality personalized or customized for individual users?

### Issues

**Issue (Navigation):** The MAP view shows zoom buttons (+ and -) and a "re-center" icon. While these are good for accessibility, there are no "accelerators" for power users, such as category filters (e.g., "Nearby Food" or "Gas Stations") directly on the map.

### Recommendations

Since the goal is a tourism app, add small shortcut "chips" or icons for common tourist needs (Restrooms, Food, Parking) directly on the map interface to speed up interaction.



## Aesthetic and Minimalist Design

**Interfaces should not contain information that is irrelevant or rarely needed. Every extra unit of information in an interface competes with the relevant units of information and diminishes their relative visibility.**

- Is the visual design and content focused on the essentials?
- Have all distracting, unnecessary elements been removed?

### Issues

**Screen:** Map

**Visual Overload in Place Details:** The "Luksohon Falls" sheet contains redundant action buttons (e.g., both a "Directions" button and a "Start" button) that clutter the primary view.

**Screen:** Schedule

**Text Hierarchy:** On the "My Schedule" screen, the use of large dates next to tiny location addresses creates a disjointed reading flow.

### Recommendations

**Simplify Actions:** Combine "Directions" and "Start" into a single primary action button to focus the user on the essential next step.

**Clean Up Metadata:** Reduce the number of icons and secondary text details displayed on initial cards to make the interface feel more modern and less busy.

# Heuristic Evaluation Workbook

## Help Users Recognize, Diagnose, and Recover from Errors

Error messages should be expressed in plain language (no error codes), precisely indicate the problem, and constructively suggest a solution.

- Does the design use traditional error message visuals, like bold, red text?
- Does the design offer a solution that solves the error immediately?

## 10 Help and

### Documentation

It's best if the system doesn't need any additional explanation. However, it may be necessary to provide documentation to help users understand how to complete their tasks.

- Is help documentation easy to search?
- Is help provided in context right at the moment when the user requires it?

### Issues

**Missing Empty States:** If a user views "My Schedule" on a day with no trips, the screen might appear broken rather than simply empty.

**Implicit Errors:** There is no clear feedback if a search for an attraction fails; the map simply remains static.

### Recommendations

**Constructive Empty States:** If no schedule exists for October 22, display a friendly message like "No trips today! Explore new destinations to add them to your schedule."

**Visual Error Cues:** Use traditional error styling, such as red text or a specific icon, if a user attempts to "Set Schedule" without selecting a valid date.

### Issues

**Contextual Help:** There are no "tooltips" or onboarding prompts to explain how to use the interactive map or the schedule sync.

### Recommendations

**Onboarding Tips:** When a user first opens the Map, provide a one-time "coach mark" or tooltip pointing to the "View Maps" button to explain its function right at the moment they need it.